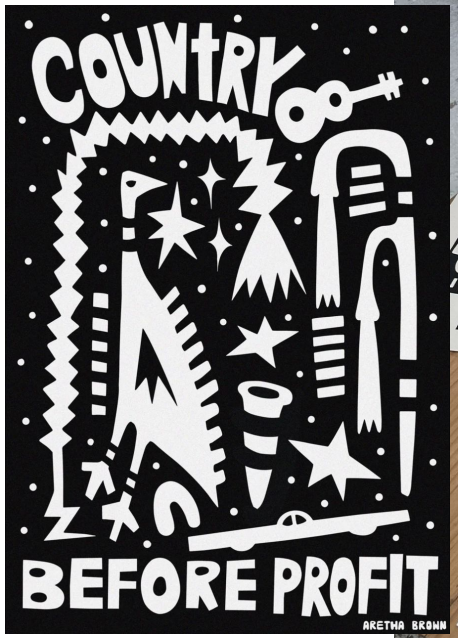
IDEA 9301

GRADUATION STUDIO

2026

SEM 2

WEEK 6: UNDERSTANDING YOUR PROJECT DIRECTION





We acknowledge that The University of Sydney was built on Gadigal lands. Sovereignty was never ceded.

This always was, and always will be Aboriginal Land.

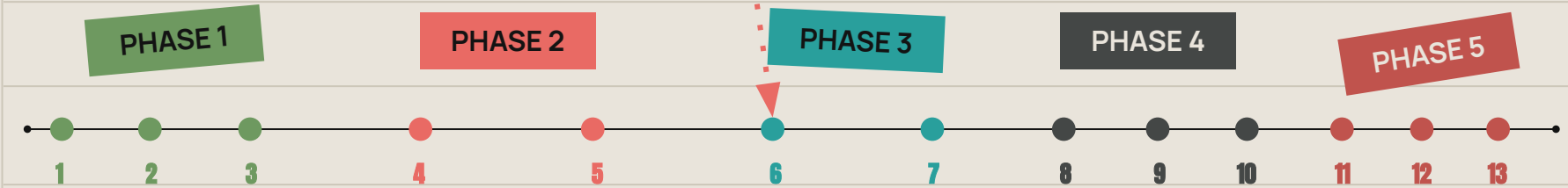
We pay our respects to the Elders of the oldest living culture on this planet, and extend our respects to all First Nations people participating in this unit as students, teachers and guests.

Aretha Brown
https://www.arethabrown.au/

Accessed 23/2/26
> Insta **@_enterthedragon_**

TIMELINE: ASSESSMENTS

We are here!



A1: WEEKLY WIP (WEEKS 4-9) 10%

A3: GROUP REFLECTION (WEEKS 5-12) 20%

WEEK 5
A2: PROJECT PROPOSAL
20%

WEEK 9 ~~8~~
A4: ~~PORTFOLIO~~ GRAD SHOW MOCK-UP
0%

WEEK 13
A5: FINAL PROJECT
50%

WEEK 6

- **Feedback** from client workshops last week
- **CoDesign** workshop tips and suggestions for next week
- From research to insight
- Pitching techniques: how to appeal to your audience

CORE MESSAGES FROM COLIN AND JODY *(AND PHIL!)*

- Jody's emphasis: focus on clear problem resolution, not simply producing an app (or a dictionary)
- Phil emphasised wanting a clear process of how students arrived at the solution *(not good enough to jump straight to the solution!)*

- *"At least 50% of groups were almost identical to the ones I saw last year"*
- 50% of ideas read the same as when you feed the brief into ChatGPT *"Same process flow, same cartoon images, same eight step community engagement protocol."*
- 10% of groups had exceptional early intellectual work, 40% had at least really engaged with the topic"

YOU GOT THIS!

“Scoping” does not mean feeding the brief into ai chatbots!

Scoping means:

- Driven by intention, not “objective”
- Looking for actionable findings, not “truth”
- Exploratory, not conclusive
- Opportunistic, not exhaustive

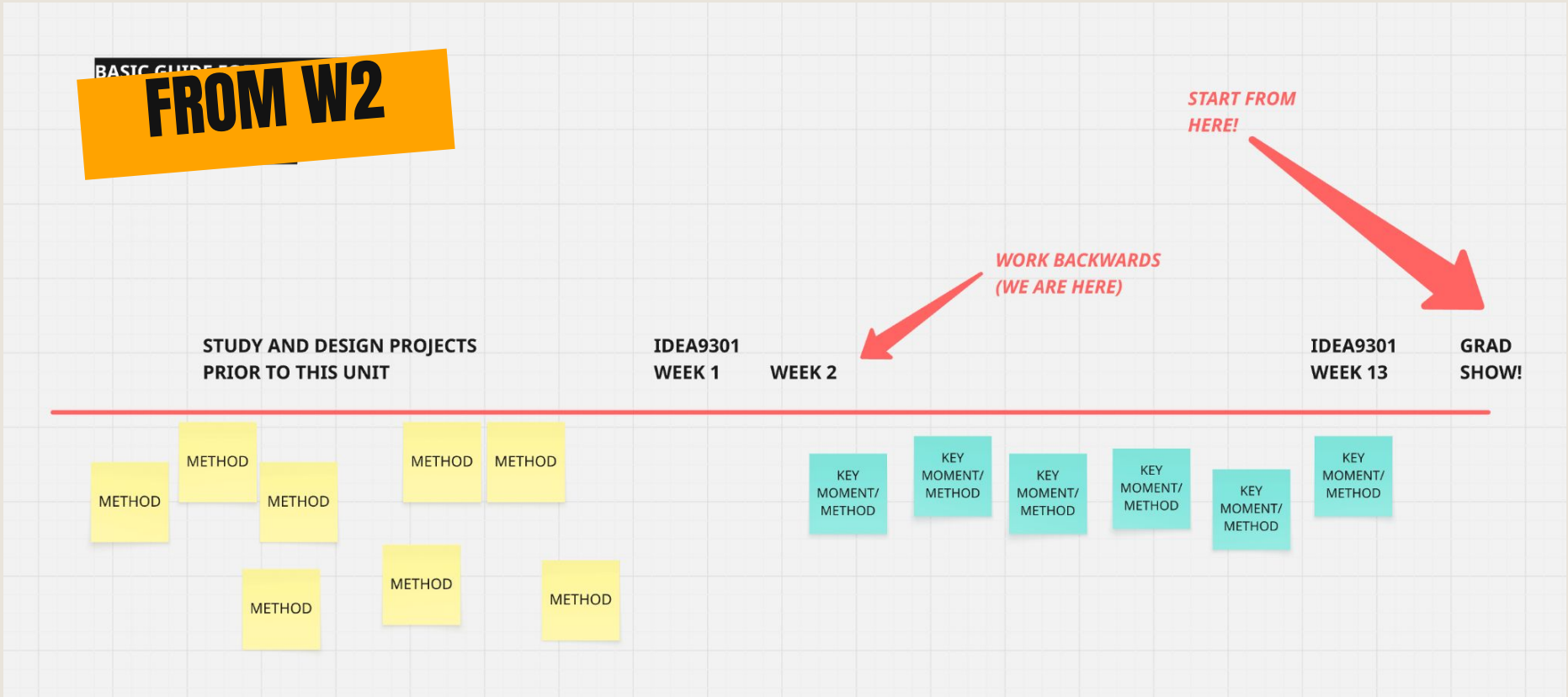
Remember to work as a team.

Remember to trust your own ideas.

Remember that AI can (and often does) suggest dumb and average stuff!

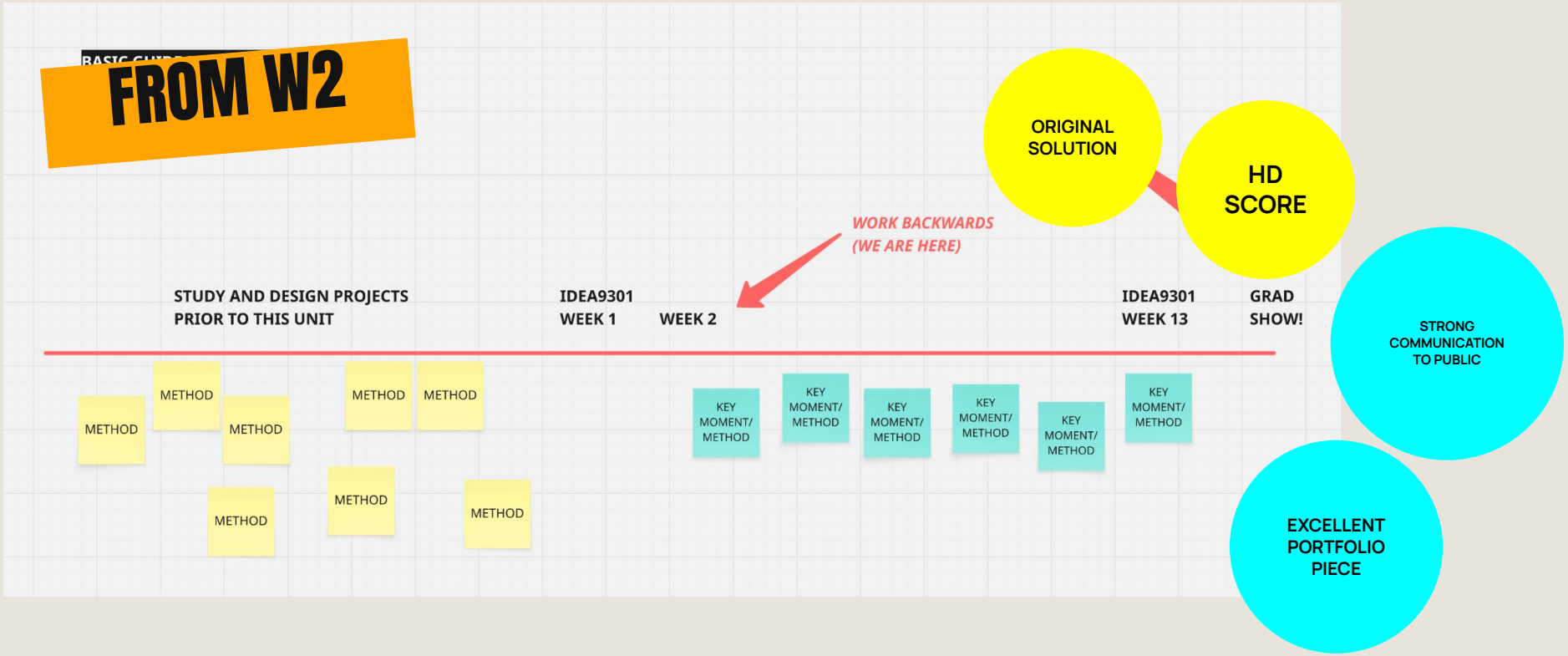
MANAGING DESIGN TENSIONS

- Is there a tension between:
  - The solution you want to create, and
  - The solution the client appears to need?
- If so, how are you negotiating that tension?
- Are there aspects of your concept that you feel particularly protective of?
  - Why are they important to you?
  - Are you open to challenging those assumptions?
  - Are there any tensions between your own goals and the project *(e.g., is there something you want for your portfolio?)*



Clare Cooper's "Design timescapes: futuring through visual thinking" (2022)
https://journals.sagepub.com/doi/abs/10.1177/14703572211065116

Clare Cooper's "Futuring Visual Communication Pedagogy: Two Visual Thinking Tools for Applied Design Futuring"
https://jfsdigital.org/2025-2/vol-30-no-2-december-2025/futuring-visual-communication-pedagogy-two-visual-thinking-tools-for-applied-design-futuring/


FROM W2
ORIGINAL SOLUTION
HD SCORE
WORK BACKWARDS (WE ARE HERE)
STUDY AND DESIGN PROJECTS PRIOR TO THIS UNIT
IDEA9301 WEEK 1
WEEK 2
IDEA9301 WEEK 13
GRAD SHOW!
METHOD
METHOD
METHOD
METHOD
METHOD
METHOD
METHOD
METHOD
KEY MOMENT/ METHOD
KEY MOMENT/ METHOD
KEY MOMENT/ METHOD
KEY MOMENT/ METHOD
KEY MOMENT/ METHOD
KEY MOMENT/ METHOD
STRONG COMMUNICATION TO PUBLIC
EXCELLENT PORTFOLIO PIECE

I AM A DESIGNER WHO...

...SHIFTS BEHAVIOURS!

...HELPS PEOPLE ENJOY LEARNING IN A SECOND LANGUAGE

...MAKES COMPLEX ENVIRONMENTAL CHALLENGES FUN AND ENGAGING

...SEES OPPORTUNITIES OTHERS DON'T

...CURES ALIENATION IN LEARNING ENVIRONMENTS

...BUILDS STRONG BRIDGES BETWEEN CULTURES

...MAKES FIGHTING CLIMATE CHANGE *FUN*

FOR WEEK 7

The clients are available from 9am–12pm.

They will move from group to group (rather than set up in one space).

They will leave at 12pm so do not assume if you wait until last, you will have time with them.

If you are unprepared for your codesign session with your client you will miss out and will need to wait until Week 11 for the validation workshop with the client as your next meeting with them.

Key questions

- Can you show your progress?
- **Have you engaged with feedback from the client?**
  - How have you taken on board their recommendations?
  - Which recommendations have you incorporated?
  - Which recommendations did you choose not to adopt, and why?
  - Has the client's feedback changed your understanding of the problem?
  - Can you identify specific examples where client feedback influenced your proposal?
- What do you most want to find out through next week's co-design workshop?
- What **assumptions** are you hoping to test? (Check next 2 slides)
- What uncertainties remain?

UNDERSTANDING YOUR PROJECT DIRECTION

1. **What do you most want to find out through next week's co-design workshop?**
    a. What assumptions are you hoping to test?
    b. What uncertainties remain?

2. **What visual artefact can you bring to help communicate your idea?**
    a. Sketches
    b. Journey maps
    c. Mock-ups
    d. Storyboards
    e. Diagrams

3. **Can you clearly demonstrate your progress since the last client interaction?**

4. **Where there any gaps in your methodology which you need to address (*building client trust is important).***

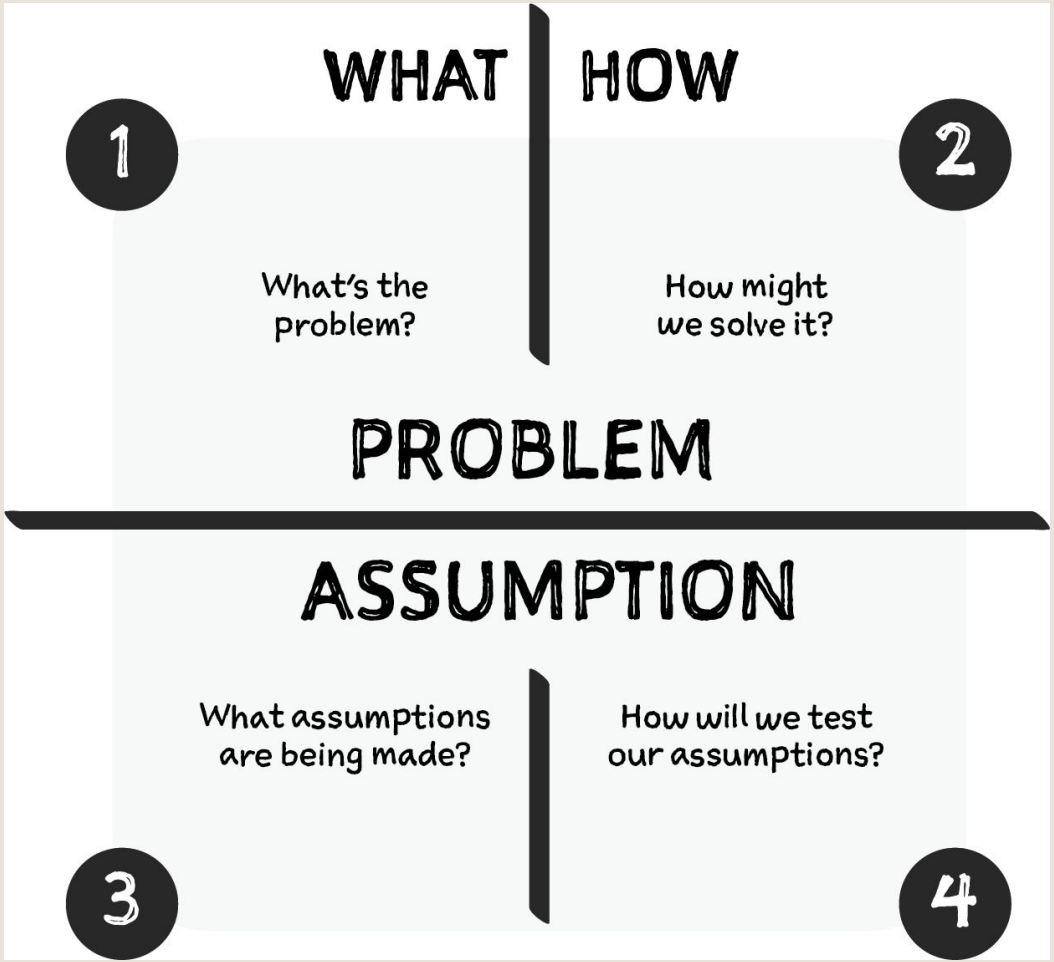
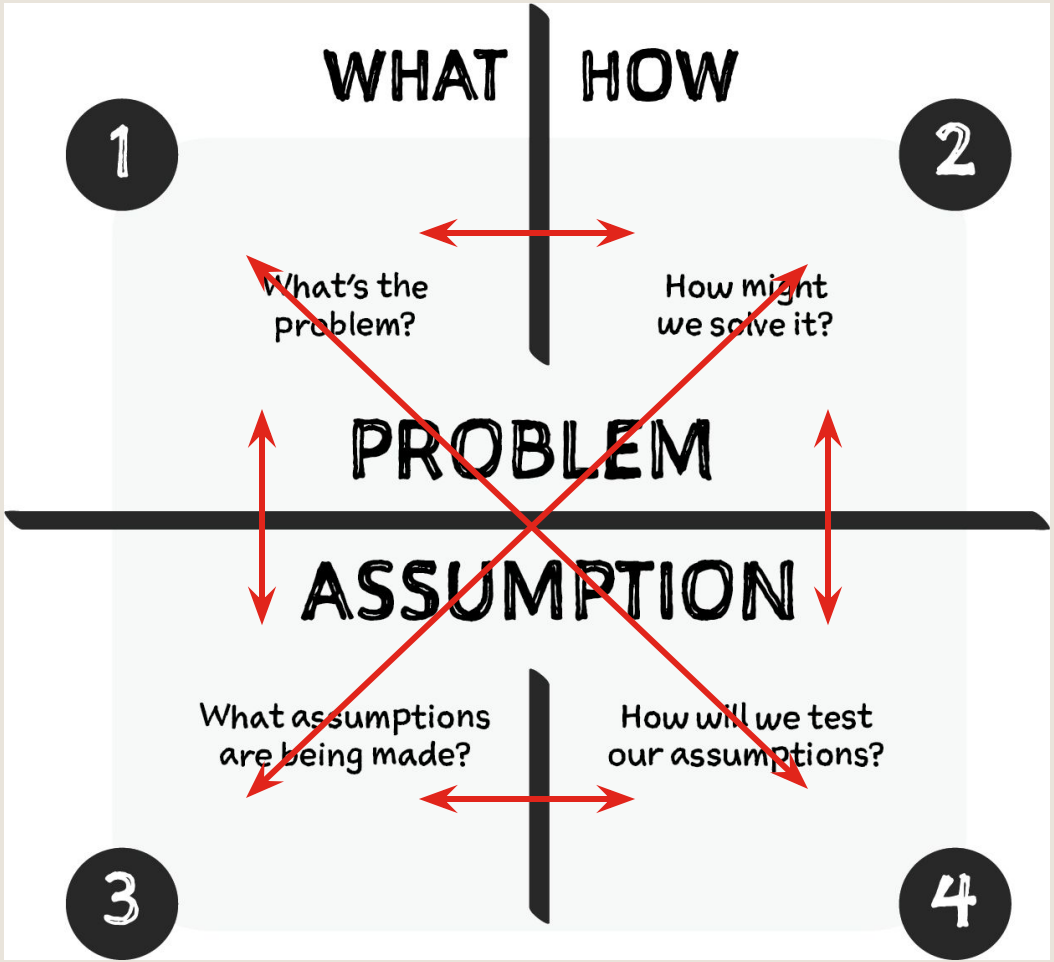


Figure 3-1. The problem-assumption model helps express problems, solutions, assumptions, and questions (source: created by Jonny Schneider and Barry O'Reilly)
https://learning.oreilly.com/library/view/lean-ux/9781449366834/


WHAT
HOW
1
2
What's the problem?
How might we solve it?
PROBLEM
ASSUMPTION
What assumptions are being made?
How will we test our assumptions?
3
4

GOING BEYOND YOUR FIRST TECHCENTRIC IDEAS...

HABITS

Does your design intervene with, question, replace, amplify, highlight, or destroy any current habits of your target audience/s?

RITUALS

Does your design intervene with, question, replace, amplify, highlight, destroy any current core rituals of your target audience/s?

SYSTEMS

Does your design intervene with, question, replace, amplify, highlight, destroy any aspects of the system supporting your project brief context?

RELATIONSHIPS

Does your design intervene with, question, replace, amplify, highlight, destroy any of the relationships you have identified through your initial research phase?

SOME IDEAS FOR CODESIGN WORKSHOPS

- What are the **most important questions** you need to ask workshop participants?
- What **evidence** or **feedback** would help you make confident design decisions following the workshop?
- What would **success look like** for your workshop participation?

Also... What can you *realistically* achieve in 10 mins?

1. FUTURE SCENARIOS

- E.g., Double variable where you have chosen a driving question and 2x axis to explore 4 scenarios that dig into key drivers of change you have identified in your research
- E.g., Backcasting from desired future using sketchnoting

2. GAMES

- E.g., Yuko Itatsu Ethical AI and research
- E.g., Fire prevention and response

3. ROLE PLAY

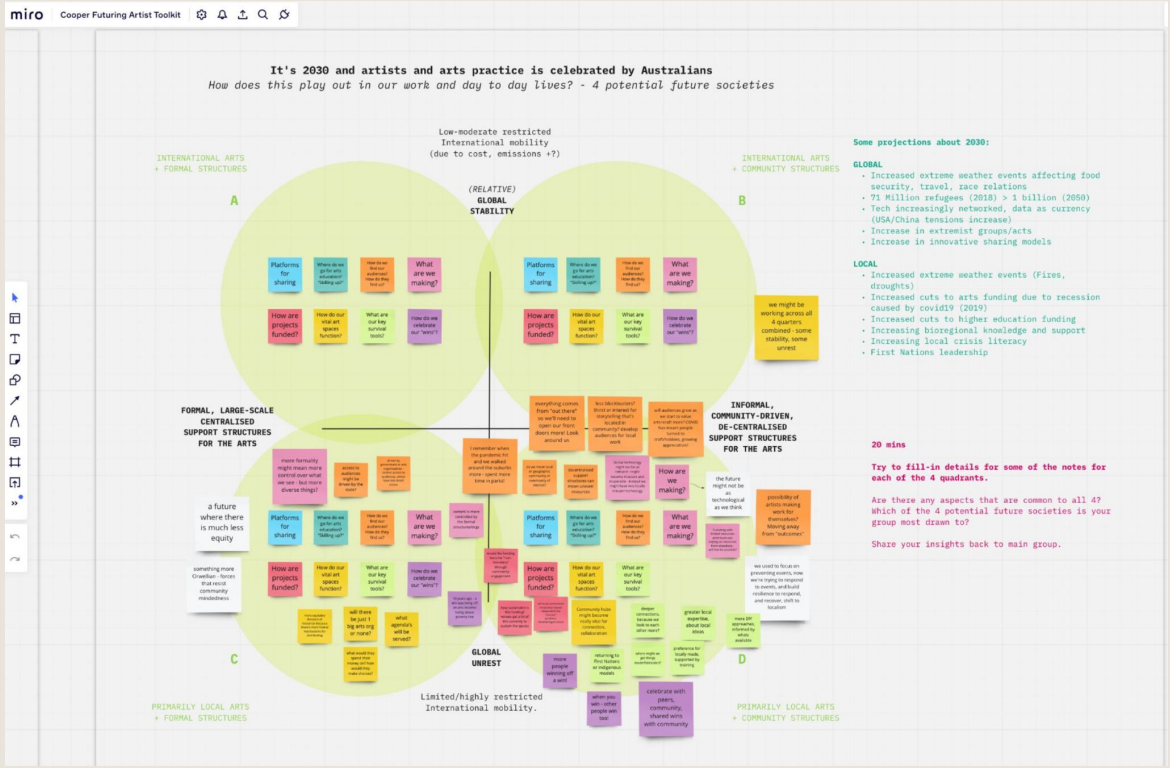
NB this is more appropriate for your validation workshops, but you could try a version of body storming or role playing to learn more about the experience of your client

Resources:

https://servicedesigntools.org/tools/role-playing

Futures/Scenario-based codesign workshop

Clare Cooper
Ainslie & Gorman Arts Centres (2021)



Consider pre-populating the scenarios and drawing attention to particular points or tensions

Futures/Scenario-based codesign workshop

Clare Cooper
Design Innovation Research Centre (2017)

Consider bringing pre-drawn stakeholders and scenes that you can stick to the timeline and draw lines to connect/add to scenes during conversation



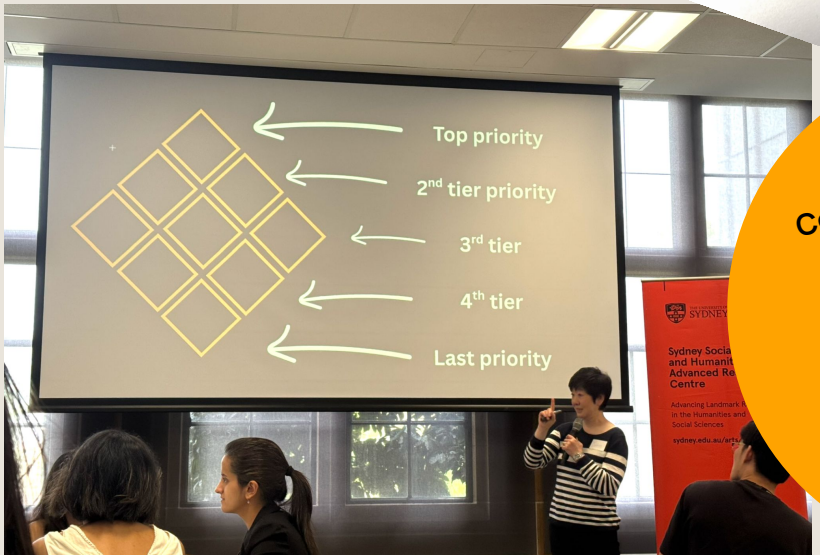
Card games-based codesign workshop

Yuko Itatsu
https://www.u-tokyo.ac.jp/en/prospective-students/guc_24S241C.html
AI and ethics workshop/game at USYD SSHARC (Feb 2026)









Consider a card game where you ask your client to SHOW you their priorities or SHOW you the tensions between elements/ stakeholders

Codesign with community for resilience, planning, recovery, governance

(Various)



QFBC Bushfire Preparedness Planning



QFBC Bushfire Community Preparedness



Githabul Peoples connecting with Country and fire



https://nrmregionsaustralia.com.au/articles/building-community-and-landholder-fire-preparedness/

https://www.paulramsayfoundation.org.au/news-resources/investing-in-community-led-decision-making

Narrate a disaster scenario that your client/stakeholder has to navigate by moving elements around on a table to show how they would respond

Futures/Scenario-based codesign workshop

Paschen et al (2026)

ELSEVIER

International Journal of Disaster Risk Reduction

Volume 144, 1 October 2026, 106373



Community-led co-design in disaster recovery: Enabling conditions for practice

Jana-Axinja Paschen, Zoe D'Arcy, Gretel Evans, Adriana Keating, Briony Rogers

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https://doi.org/10.1016/j.ijdrr.2026.106373

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"The paper contributes empirical and conceptual insights by identifying the conditions that enabled shifting co-design from a participatory method to an approach to relational governance."
https://www.sciencedirect.com/science/article/pii/S2212420926003857

Building empathy through role playing

Example by National University of Singapore, Service Design Lab

https://servicedesigntools.org/tools/role-playing





Create some exaggerated elements where each of you play a persona or stakeholder and play out a scene to reveal tensions or opportunities

SCOPING FOR DISCOVERY!

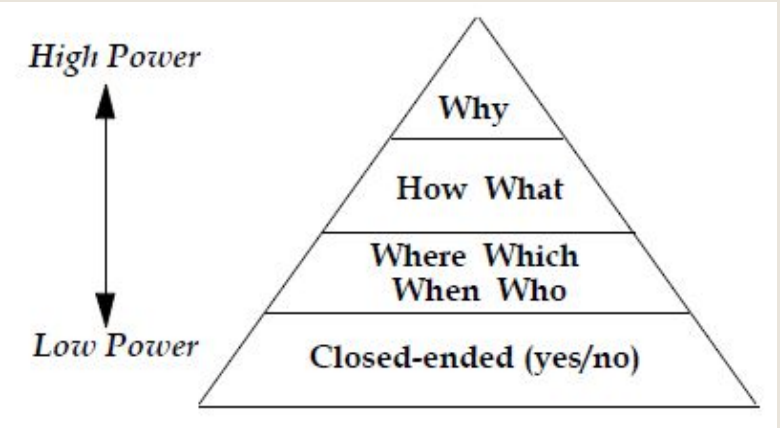
- Promising leads & findings
- Information and Inspiration
- Identifying (and challenging) assumptions
- Not “what is conclusively true”, rather “what is possible and preferable”
- Formulate powerful questions

>> Piloting moves secondary to primary data

Powerful questions:

- are **open-ended**
- generate **curiosity**
- stimulate reflective **conversation**
- are **thought-provoking**
- surface underlying **assumptions**
- invite **creativity** and new possibilities
- generate **energy** and forward movement
- channel attention and focuses **inquiry**
- **stay** with participants
- touch a deep **meaning**
- **evoke** more questions





https://www.scribd.com/document/18675626/Art-of-Powerful-Questions

Findings in discovery phase can be:

- Results from research studies
- Recommendations from industry reports
- Findings from literature reviews
- Implications for practice from academic papers
- **Factual, descriptive, assessable**
- Provide a springboard to leap into not-provable directions using abductive logic

University of Lapland, Faculty of Art and Design

Title: Exploring the User Experience of Self-checkout Systems through Design

Author: Jemina Colley

Degree Program: Industrial Design

Type: Pro gradu

Pages: 76

Date: 13.05.2025

Abstract

This thesis explores user experiences and expectations of self-checkout (SC) systems in grocery stores, focusing on both usability and socio-technical aspects. Using a mixed-method approach, including heuristic evaluation, thematic media analysis, design prototyping, a user study and an online survey, I investigated how users perceive current SC systems and what design improvements they might desire. The findings show that while users appreciate the efficiency of SC systems, they frequently encounter issues such as cramped layouts, inconsistent features, usability errors, and limited accessibility. Emotional and social factors, including past negative experiences, feelings of being watched, and a desire for human interaction, also influence their perceptions. Based on these insights, I propose design improvements that emphasise clearer user interfaces, better spatial design, enhanced accessibility, and a stronger human presence in SC areas. These recommendations aim to support designers, developers, and store owners in creating more inclusive, user-friendly, and socially aware self-service technologies.

6 DISCUSSION



Figure 9: User study prototype.

is section, I will interpret my results, compare them with results from related answer my research questions, and discuss the practical and theoretical cations and limitations of my thesis.

Interpretation of Results

indings of my thesis show that while users generally find SC systems functional convenient, their experience depends on more than just the interface design. cipants successfully completed tasks using the lo-fi prototype, appreciating its y and ease of use. However, the broader findings reveal that current SC systems often face challenges from inconsistent features, physical limitations, and a lack of accessibility. Participants reported feeling cramped in SC areas, encountering difficulties with scanning and weighing items, and requiring more staff assistance in stores. Furthermore, many users valued staff presence not only for practical support but also for social interaction.

These practical issues become more significant when coupled with emotional and social factors. Past negative experiences with technology can shape users' expectations and

Piloting primary data

Use secondary findings to draft a handful of questions for your **scoping interviews** and codesign workshops (if you are doing this next week and beyond)

- ➔ Formulate powerful questions (to yourself, teammates, key available stakeholders)
- ➔ Iterate: to test findings, explore further, reveal issues, consider causal relations, local relevance...

From secondary to primary

You are using **secondary research** to get acquainted with terms, issues, challenges, solutions. Go across academic, commercial, customer voice, experts, etc.

An opportunistic discovery process: not *exhaustive*, but *exploratory*

What is interesting? What is useful? What suggests new needs or possibilities?

Identify a couple/few relevant, reliable & informative sources

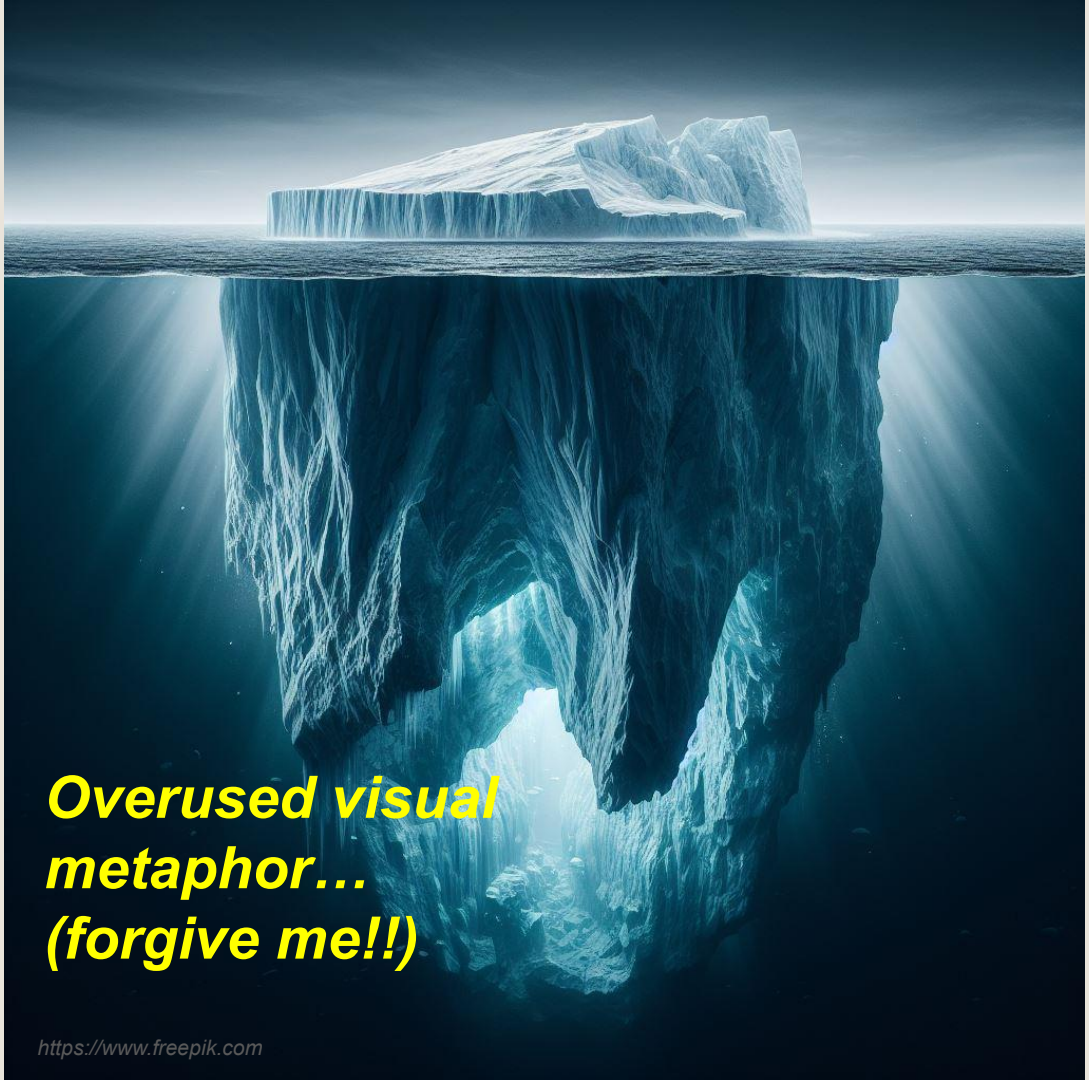
Use their findings/limitations **to inform your own inquiry**

Has anyone tried X? How else could this be done? What else? Who else?

Prepare and conduct some **piloting** (bird-in-hand principle)

To test, confirm a finding; to dig deeper?

To understand issues/causes/impacts? To assess in this context?



FINDINGS

Descriptive, factual findings

INSIGHTS

What that means for possible design action

BANANA INSIGHTS?



Findings:

Long list of banana facts

Insights:

Interesting, useful things you can do with said facts

An iterative process: *findings >> insights >> piloting*

https://freepngimg.com/png/4844-banana-png-image

delish

Best Ways To Use A Banana At Every Stage

		Best Ways To Use	Recipes
Very Unripe	Very firm, dense, starchy, chalky, minimal sweetness and fragrance	Cooked (treat like a root vegetable!)	Fried green bananas, green banana curry, mashed green bananas
Underripe	Firm, half starchy, half sweet, mellow, a bit astringent	Cooked, or eat raw	Pan fried honey bananas, deep fried bananas, bananas foster
Just Ripe	Tender, creamy, mostly sweet, fragrant	Eat raw, use in desserts	Fruit smoothie, upside down banana cake, banana cream pudding, grilled bananas
Very Ripe	Very soft, sweet, and fragrant	Eat raw, use in desserts, freeze for later use	Banana pancakes, banana nut muffins, “nice” creams
Overripe	Mushy, translucent, syrupy sweet	Use in desserts, freeze for later use	Banana bread, banana waffles, banana oatmeal



- Scratch messages into the peel with a toothpick -the message slowly darkens as it oxidizes
- Banana peels are rich in potassium and phosphorus -great for plants!
- Rub the inside of the peel on leather shoes or bags, then buff with a soft cloth for shine
- Ferment banana peels to create a unique vinegar, often used in Filipino or Caribbean cooking
- Blend banana peel with water and use the paste to polish tarnished silverware

From findings to insights: interpretative, actionable, include intuition and experience, open scenarios and possibilities, broad applicability



https://www.delish.com/cooking/recipe-ideas https://nourishingtime.com/mashed-green-bananas/ https://www.instagram.com/p/CTZvcDNLffq/

INSIGHTS IN DISCOVERY

- Insights are interpretations of findings
- Insights occur “when a person suddenly reinterprets a stimulus, situation, or event to produce a nonobvious interpretation” (Kounios and Beeman, 2014)
- Aha moments: “Frequently accompanied by a burst of emotion, a highly positive surprise”
- Insights **go beyond** the analysis and the data, they require creative input to process and **(re)interpret findings** to reframe a problem

https://doi.org/10.1146/annurev-psych-010213-115154



Back to the lift example from week 2…

Finding: People complain about slow lifts

~~Solution (bad): Replace lifts with faster models~~

Insight: Change how people <u>experience time</u> in lifts

Simple resolution: Install mirrors in lifts, keep people busy/distracted



Tourism Management
Volume 67, August 2018, Pages 224-236

Exploring tourists' memorable hospitality experiences: An Airbnb perspective

Erose Sthapit, Jano Jiménez-Barreto

6.2. Managerial implications, limitations and future research

From a practical point of view, the results of the current study offer important managerial implications. The main motives driving people to stay in Airbnb accommodation includes price and location, therefore, Airbnb hosts should focus on offering an affordable price and write a clear description of the proximity of the accommodation to tourist attractions. In addition, some of the guests wanted the comforts of a home while staying in an Airbnb accommodation, therefore, hosts should offer the basic amenities and make them feel like home. Moreover, given that memorable Airbnb experiences were related to the social interactions with the host, the attitude of the host and the location of the accommodation, this study calls for a shift in the Airbnb host's role from offering cheap rental accommodation to being memorable experience co-creators. For example, hosts should actively interact with the guests, check them in and answer questions linked to the accommodation. Airbnb hosts should consider interaction as a resource that helps guests to have a memorable stay and should provide information about sightseeing, restaurant options and transportation. This will help the guests to make the optimum use of the time spent at the destination and increase the value. To create a more memorable experience, hosts should treat their guests in a friendly manner throughout their stay.

From findings:

- Comforts of a home: *"make them feel like home"*
- Reframing the host's role to *"being memorable experience co-creators"* https://doi.org/10.1016/j.tmp.2018.08.006

...to insights:

- Host-guest alignment
- Customisation
- Negotiating expectations
- Home: "more than a bed"

...to ~~solutions~~ (not for now):

- Survey to match: interests, cultural preferences, etc.
- Day activities, diet, etc.
- Reconfigurable décor

...to brainstorming problem/opportunity



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Piloting:

- Prepare tentative questions
- Reach out to stakeholders
- Informal, semi-structured conversations
- Pay attention, listen actively
- Do not record
- Keep anonymity
- Identify & address ethical risks
- Indicative, not conclusive results
- **Iterate**: piloting-insights-HMW

Brainstorming problem/opportunity:

- Apply creative ideation techniques to formulate insights (interpret findings and interpret piloting responses)

5 WS AND HMW PROBLEM FRAMING (reminder)

The “5Ws” technique to write HMW:

- Who is impacted?
- What problem do they face?
- Where does this problem come up?
- When does the problem occur? How?
- Why does the problem matter? What’s the likely impact?

A good HMW is clear, specific, and focused on the user’s challenge. It directly identifies the problem, its impact on users, and why solving it is important. It should **guide a design process without anticipating a solution**.

HOW MIGHT WE (reminder)

HMW: Technique introduced by Procter & Gamble in the 1970s, popularized by IDEO

HMWs format:

HMW (intended action) to achieve (result) for (user) because (insight)?

Examples:

- ➔ HMW make healthy eating appealing to busy people?
- ➔ HMW inspire teenagers to learn to cook healthier food?
- ➔ HMW make healthy breakfast available to university students who struggle to wake up?
- ➔ HMW increase nutritious food demand to make it more affordable?

Problem Statements: HMW examples

Not a Problem Statement	Bad Problem Statement	Good Problem Statement
“People make mistakes because they don’t read instructions”	“HMW… make people read instructions so they don’t make mistakes?”	“HMW… eliminate written instructions altogether?”
“Self-checkouts increase frustration and shoplifting”	“HMW… deter shoplifting in self-checkouts?”	“HMW… pay for groceries more swiftly and reliably without manually scanning each item individually?”
“The metaverse is the next chapter of the internet”	“HMW… fix the loneliness epidemic with AI companions?”	“HMW… support people grow meaningful, sustained relationships in their local communities fostering belonging and inclusion?”

To form strong HMWs:

solid secondary sources (findings, ideas, questions, gaps) >> piloting to examine, unfold, test, identify issues, understand things better >> interpret insights >> draft HMWs >> iterate

HMW early ideas as directions to solve

Not a Problem Statement	Bad Problem Statement	Good Problem Statement	Early creative ideas
“People make mistakes because they don’t read instructions”	“HMW… make people read instructions so they don’t make mistakes?”	“HMW… eliminate written instructions altogether?”	Voice guidance? Diagrams and drawings? Integrated sensors with feedback?
“Self-checkouts increase frustration and shoplifting”	“HMW… deter shoplifting in self-checkouts?”	“HMW… pay for groceries more swiftly and reliably without manually scanning each item individually?”	Phone scanning self-checkout? Smart carts/baskets? Bulk-scan with RFID tags? Just-Walk-Out tech? Subscription?
“The metaverse is the next chapter of the internet”	“HMW… fix the loneliness epidemic with AI companions?”	“HMW… support people grow meaningful, sustained relationships in their local communities fostering belonging and inclusion?”	Geo-located platforms and ‘serious games’? Local support social networks? Care networks? Advocacy & civic groups?

To form strong HMWs:

solid secondary sources (findings, ideas, questions, gaps) >> piloting to examine, unfold, test, identify issues, understand things better >> interpret insights >> draft HMWs >> iterate

YOUR PITCH!

How to appeal to your audience

Pitching: not just presenting your work.

Shaping your work so that it is compelling to your specific and context.

So far, we have:

- A brief
- A problem
- Research
- A Methodology
- A budget

Our pitch is what joins all these together, and guides our graphic design, our layout, our language, focus and more.

Pitch: Components

Who is the speaker? (you / your team)

Who is the audience? (the client)

What is the message? (your proposal)

What is the context? (tender, constraints, urgency)

	Speaker	Audience	Message	Context
Bluegreen	Design team (community + sustainability focus)	Local council / community innovation centre	We can activate community participation	Tender for community space
CALD education	Education-focused design team	University faculty / unit coordinators	We improve participation and learning outcomes	Internal university project

PITCH APPEAL

We can split up different types of arguments or appeal into different categories.

In a pitch we need to use all of these, but some audiences and contexts require more of some than others.

LOGOS (LOGIC)

- evidence
- research
- feasibility
- budget

👉 “This works”

PATHOS (EMOTION)

- urgency
- impact
- user experience
- consequences

👉 “This matters”

ETHOS (CREDIBILITY/VALUES)

- your expertise
- alignment with client goals
- professionalism

👉 “You can trust us”

Pitching: A great example



https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=PczCM3GwB4Q

Pitching example analysis

Element	What the speaker does	Why it works	Mode of persuasion
Opening	Starts with a live clap interaction	Immediate engagement, creates curiosity	**Pathos** (emotion / attention)
Problem framing	Connects everyday action to serious neurological conditions	Makes the problem relatable and meaningful	**Pathos → Logos**
Problem clarity	Uses simple analogy (“like understanding a movie from one frame”)	Simplifies complex ideas, easy to understand	**Logos** (clear explanation)
Insight	Focuses on relationships between signals, not just data	Shows deeper thinking beyond the obvious	**Insight / differentiation**
Approach	Introduces AI + wearable data in simple terms	Communicates solution without jargon	**Logos** (feasibility)
Metaphor	Brain + body as an orchestra	Memorable, human-centred explanation	**Pathos + clarity**
Outcome	Early detection, improved treatment	Clearly shows value and impact	**Logos + Pathos**
Closing	Returns to clapping / human experience	Creates a narrative loop and emotional impact	**Pathos**
Speaker	Confident, clear, credible researcher	Builds trust without over-explaining	**Ethos**
Overall	Balanced use of logic, emotion, and credibility	Engaging, clear, and persuasive	**Logos + Pathos + Ethos**

Pitch: Audience changes everything - their goals, constraints and language

Brief	Speaker	Message	Audience	What they care about	Appeal
Bluegreen	Design team (community + sustainability focus)	We activate community participation	Local council / community	Community engagement, measurable outcomes, funding justification	Logos + Pathos
CALD education	Education-focused design team	We improve participation and learning outcomes	University faculty / unit coordinators	Student outcomes, staff workload, implementation feasibility	Logos + Ethos

Integration into Your Assignment

1. **Frame the problem** (why this matters): clear, specific, grounded.

2. **Show insight** (what others missed): tension, constraints, system.

3. **Present your approach** (how you will solve it): methodology why this method?

4. **Show outcomes** (what they get): deliverables impact.

5. **Justify resources** (why this is reasonable): budget, time, team.

6. **Why you** (this is the pitch): your strengths, your fit.

Work to do…

- Adjust your language to match your audience
- Emphasise what they care about, not just what you made
- Your proposal should read as one consistent argument
    - **Problem → shows relevance**
    - **Methodology → fits constraints**
    - **Outcome → delivers value**
    - **Budget → proves feasibility**

They should all be telling the same story!

Checklist

- ❑ Does your proposal align with the client's goals?
- ❑ Does your language align with the clients' values?
- ❑ Does your graphic design and layout match your language?
- ❑ Does what you emphasise align with the clients' values?
- ❑ Does your methodology fit the problem?
- ❑ Does your budget reflect your method?
- ❑ Does your tone sound confident and specific?
- ❑ Would a client choose this over another proposal?

IDEA9301
STUDIO WEEK 6

Tutorial activities

10.00am – 10:30am	**WIPs**
10.30am – 11:30am	**Activity 1:** Rebriefing
11:30am – 12pm	**Activity 2:** Research planning

Studio schedule

1:00pm – 1:30pm	**Elevator pitch practice**
1:30pm – 3:30pm	**Workshopping your codesign workshop for next week!**
3.30pm – 4:00pm	**Retrospectives**

Search

1 Message

Summarise

Clint McBossface
A2 proposal outcome
To: admin@young-desingers.xyz

Inbox - Google 9:46 am

Dear Design Team,

We are pleased to inform you that, following a competitive selection process, your A2 proposal has been successful.

After careful review, your response to the brief demonstrated a strong and compelling interpretation, and has been selected to progress. You are therefore invited to proceed to the next phase and undertake delivery of the project.

We look forward to working with you as you further develop and articulate your approach. Please proceed in line with your proposed direction. Further details regarding next steps and project timelines will be shared shortly.

Kind regards,

Client



Congratulations!!!

Your proposal was selected by the client.

What happens next?

Hint – it is NOT solution time!

CORE MESSAGES FROM COLIN AND JODY *(AND PHIL!)*

- Jody's emphasis: focus on clear problem resolution, not simply producing an app (or a dictionary)
- Phil emphasised wanting a clear process of how students arrived at the solution *(not good enough to jump straight to the solution!)*

- *"At least 50% of groups were almost identical to the ones I saw last year"*
- 50% of ideas read the same as when you feed the brief into ChatGPT *"Same process flow, same cartoon images, same eight step community engagement protocol."*
- 10% of groups had exceptional early intellectual work, 40% had at least really engaged with the topic"

YOU GOT THIS!

MANAGING DESIGN TENSIONS

- Is there a tension between:
  - The solution you want to create, and
  - The solution the client appears to need?
- If so, how are you negotiating that tension?
- Are there aspects of your concept that you feel particularly protective of?
  - Why are they important to you?
  - Are you open to challenging those assumptions?
  - Are there any tensions between your own goals and the project *(e.g., is there something you want for your portfolio?)*

FOR WEEK 7

The clients are available from 9am–12pm.

They will move from group to group (rather than set up in one space).

They will leave at 12pm so do not assume if you wait until last, you will have time with them.

If you are unprepared for your codesign session with your client you will miss out and will need to wait until Week 11 for the validation workshop with the client as your next meeting with them.

Key questions

- Can you show your progress?
- **Have you engaged with feedback from the client?**
  - How have you taken on board their recommendations?
  - Which recommendations have you incorporated?
  - Which recommendations did you choose not to adopt, and why?
  - Has the client's feedback changed your understanding of the problem?
  - Can you identify specific examples where client feedback influenced your proposal?
- What do you most want to find out through next week's co-design workshop?
- What **assumptions** are you hoping to test? (Check next 2 slides)
- What uncertainties remain?

UNDERSTANDING YOUR PROJECT DIRECTION

1. **What do you most want to find out through next week's co-design workshop?**
    a. What assumptions are you hoping to test?
    b. What uncertainties remain?

2. **What visual artefact can you bring to help communicate your idea?**
    a. Sketches
    b. Journey maps
    c. Mock-ups
    d. Storyboards
    e. Diagrams

3. **Can you clearly demonstrate your progress since the last client interaction?**

4. **Where there any gaps in your methodology which you need to address (*building client trust is important).***

PROBLEM FRAMING AND PROJECT EVALUATION

Re-briefing is not restarting the project! It is an intentional refinement of project direction. Mature design practice involves revisiting assumptions and redefining goals.

Key Concepts:

Re-briefing

- Revisit and redefine the problem based on what has been learned.
- Establish revised project goals and success criteria.

Reverse Briefing

- Clearly articulate your understanding of the problem back to the client.
- Define your own "goal posts" before moving forward.

Looking at your current solution, how closely does it align with the original brief? What evidence supports your assessment?

What next: Rebrief

What is a Rebrief (AKA statement of intent)

When you first engage a client or work on a project, it is important to complete a statement of intent or rebrief. This is your re-interpretation of the brief the client gave you.

It justifies and explains **how** you are viewing the problem. Importantly it also sets the **scope** of the project with hard limits and plainly states how your team is interpreting the **clients needs**.

This is sent to the client for approval, and acknowledgment, and it will set the boundaries against which your work is measured. If it's **not** in the rebrief, it should **not** be in the debrief.

10:30 - 10:45am

A **Rebrief** (reverse brief) or a **Statement of intent** are documents you prepare early on in the project.

They give:

Protection for your team.

Convey your **approach**.

Clarity for everyone involved.

What next: Rebrief

What is a Rebrief (AKA statement of intent)

A rebrief will contain a some of the work you have done so far in refining the problem, extending to different stakeholders through de, and re-lamination, and validating your assumptions and constraints.

It focuses on:

Alignment Check: It ensures that what the team thought the client wanted during the bidding phase is actually what the client needs now that work is starting.

Gap Identification: It allows the team to officially flag any risks or missing information they spotted in the original brief before they begin designing.

Establishing the Scope: Once the client signs off on the reverse brief, it often becomes the new "baseline" for the project, protecting the design team from unexpected extra work (scope creep).

10:30 - 10:45am

Your client will **read** and **agree** to/**acknowledge** in writing, your rebrief at the start of the project.

Activity 1: Rebrief

Make a rebrief that is client ready

Here is a basic template with some guiding text and examples.

Use it to make your own rebrief. Remember this goes to the client so your layout, design and language would need to be tailored to match the client's context.

https://www.figma.com/board/XvrMxfmVTwH9c8jpcnvHS4/Week-6-Rebrief?node-id=0-1&t=V218jHsTsKrEV8wx-1

10:45 - 11:30am

Make sure to re-define any vague client terms.

Use the client's own language but scaffold it with observable and measurable outcomes.

Client briefs often use broad terms like “better”, “engaging”, “accessible”, or “secure". Translate these into clear, specific, and shared definitions.

Research planning

Turn the brief into research questions

From your briefs, you are not researching everything.
You are finding what matters.

Examples:
- Community values and participation (BlueGreen)
- How students learn across language and cultural barriers (Design@Sydney)

Translate into:
- What do people currently do?
- What problems do they actually experience?
- What do they value?
- What stops change from happening?

11:30 - 12:00pm

How can we move from these broad categories to gather enough specific information to start responding to the briefs?

Understanding who you need to talk to is the first step. Go to your stakeholder map, or de-and re-lamination analysis and check which groups or stakeholders need to contribute.

Research must do one of three things:
- Confirm the problem exists
- Clarify who it affects and how
- Test your assumptions

If your research does not change a decision, it is not useful.

Research planning

Who do you need to talk to?

Don’t just get the most obvious stakeholders.

- Primary users
- Edge cases (extreme users – minimal users)
- Stakeholders (organisations, facilitators, experts)
- People affected but not directly involved

Be realistic – how much time can you expect to get with people? How will you use that time efficiently?

Common mistakes

- Talking to only friends
- Asking vague questions
- Asking about the future
- Collecting data without a purpose
- Ignoring consent
- Keeping identifiable data

11:30 - 12:00pm

Who are these people

Where are these people?

How will I reach them?

Do I need to go somewhere physically?

Will they give me their time?

Recruitment can take a long time.

Let secondary research guide you.

Who has done similar research?
How did they achieve it?
Who did they talk to?
What methods or questions did they use?

Research planning

Consent and anonymisation

You must clearly state:

- Who you are
- What the research is for
- What will happen to the data
- That participation is voluntary
- That they can stop at any time

No consent → no recording/interview/survey

Anonymisation is not just removing names.
It means:

- No identifying details
- No traceable context
- No way to link data back to a person

11:30 - 12:00pm

“Hi, I’m a design student working on a university project.

I’d like to ask you a few questions about your experience.

With your permission, I’d like to record this so I don’t miss anything.
The recording will only be used for this project and won’t be shared publicly.

You can stop at any time or ask me to delete it.

Is that okay?”

Research planning

Designing a strong survey

Every question must map to a decision
If you don’t know how a question will influence your design, delete it.

Avoid “data hoarding”
Only include if it affects the problem (age, gender, address)

Keep it short
5 -10 questions
2-3 minutes

11:30 - 12:00pm

There will always be noise and outliers in your survey results.

Signal
Repeated patterns across multiple people

Noise
Random, inconsistent, one-off responses

Outliers
Unusual but sometimes important responses

Outliers are not automatically wrong. They can reveal edge cases or overlooked problems.

Research planning

Methods (keep it practical)

Use interviews when:
You need depth, stories, motivations
Finds: Trends, frequency, segmentation

Use surveys when:
You need patterns across many people
Finds: Stories, motivations, nuance

Use observation when:
People don't accurately describe behaviour
Finds: Reality of actions

Use secondary research when:
The problem is already well studied, and supplement your primary research.

11:30 - 12:00pm

Most projects will use a variety of methods.

Don't rely on one to gather all your information.

Do you need numbers to prove something?

Do you need experience to understand something?

Secondary research can help understand what to ask and how. How have other projects found the same information.

Research planning

Designing good questions

Avoid:
- Leading questions
- Yes/no questions
- Asking about the future (“would you use…”)

Instead:
- Ask about real behaviour
- Ask about recent experiences
- Ask for examples

Bad:
“Would you use a system that improves resilience?”

Good:
“Tell me about the last time something broke or failed and how you dealt with it”

11:30 - 12:00pm

Make sure to let people answer for themselves, don’t lead them to answers.

Make sure you ask permission to record.

Use consent forms.

Make it an easy and conformable process for your interviewees (i.e. not outside in the rain)

Research planning

What is enough data?

You will need to check the responses as you are collecting data. There may be instances where you need to rethink you questions or approach.

When do we have enough data:

- You hear the same patterns repeated
- You can clearly describe 2–3 key insights
- You can justify a design direction
- Also - never

You need to rethink when:

- Everyone says something different
- You can’t explain the problem clearly
- Your idea is not supported by what you heard
- Also - always

11:30 - 12:00pm

Like all parts of a design process this should be flexible.

Be ready to shift, change your questions, adjust your surveys and in general improve your data collection along the way.

It can be a great idea to split up and have different people checking the data and doing rough analysis as it is being collected.

Research planning

How will you analyse it?

Once you have your interviews, survey results, filled questionnaires, online ethnography data or polls gathered from your research you need to analyse it. You might have a lot of different and complex data, and analysis can be a balancing act between complex outputs and oversimplification.

Before you collect data, decide what outcome would make you change your direction.

- If 80% say location matters more than security → rethink focus
- If theft is rare but perception is high → focus on perception

Look for patterns, tensions, contradictions

- needs
- behaviours
- barriers

Output should be:

- 2–4 key insights
- Not raw data

11:30 - 12:00pm

Common mistakes:

- Talking to the wrong people
- Asking vague or leading questions
- Collecting data without knowing why
- Not planning how to analyse
- Relying only on surveys
- Ignoring secondary research

LUNCH
(12pm – 1pm)



Presentation Coaching

Draft your Elevator Pitch

Prepare to present your drafted elevator pitch for your class.

It's a quick summary, 50+ words, to introduce your idea in 30-60 seconds. Practise within the group, then 1 person can present to the class.

Text: use 'and, but, therefore…' approach from Podclass.

Think about the structure of your pitch.
Who's the speaker? Who's the audience?
What's the message? What's the context?

Appeal: What are you appealing to?
- Logos (Logical)
- Pathos (Emotional)
- Ethos (Values)

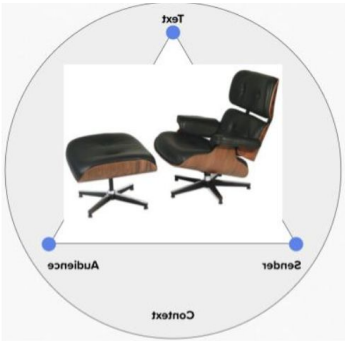
1. Project your voice! Raise your head and talk to the back corners of the room. When presenting to the class, your voice should project over people's heads.

2. Get excited when you need to! Use your voice, energy, hands, walking, and looking. Show enthusiasm for your topic!

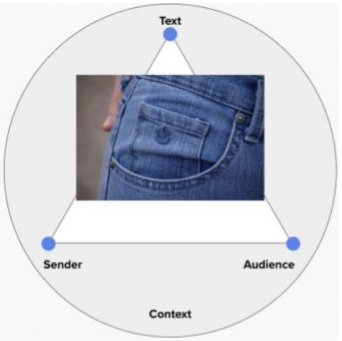
3. Get some feedback. How can we improve our pitch?

Building rhetorical awareness: Sender, audience, message and context.

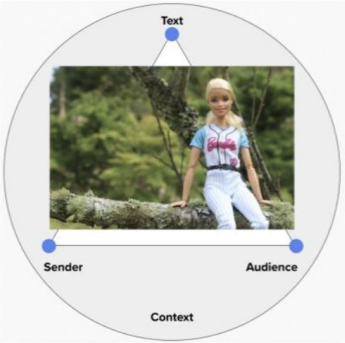
Discuss the following items with your classmates.













<u>Practice:</u> How might you convince someone to get a Cold and Flu vaccine by appealing to [logos, pathos, ethos]? 20min

Choose 1 option: logos, pathos, ethos and create discuss with your team mates.

<u>Exercise:</u> What's the sender/audience/message/context of these different designs: (40min)

- A Lamborghini *ie. the driver is sending a message to the world.*
- A Lego set
- A train carriage
- A Barbie doll
- Vape/e-cigarette advertising
- A company ESG website
- put any design here to analyse it…
- **Consider these approaches within your pitch.**

PREPARING FOR CODESIGN WORKSHOPS NEXT WEEK (week 7)

Also... What can you *realistically* achieve in 10 mins?

- What are the **most important questions** you need to ask workshop participants?
- What **evidence** or **feedback** would help you make confident design decisions following the workshop?
- What would **success look like** for your workshop participation?

NEXT WEEK groups should arrive with:

➔ A clear workshop objective.
➔ Workshop questions or activities prepared.
➔ Visual material supporting communication.
➔ Evidence of project progress.
➔ A draft understanding of what you need to learn from participants.

Check Clare’s masterclass example slides and references if you missed them

- ❏ Problem statement and validation checkup.
- ❏ Continue to work on your assignments.
- ❏ Find a workflow that allows for collaboration and and streamlined updates.
- ❏ Separate and delegate – who is in charge of what? Delegate according to your skills…

  Delegation

  Budget

  Text

  Layout

  Graphic design

  Diagrams

  Illustrations

Student readiness check for Week 7

- ❑ A codesign workshop objective.
- ❑ A set of codesign questions.
- ❑ A facilitation plan.
- ❑ Workshop materials and visuals ready.
- ❑ Clarity on the data you hope to gather during the workshop.

Studio – Retrospectives (3:30pm – 4:00pm)

Moving these to next time… unless some of you want to use them this week in studio